CASE STUDY

Mawsynram, world's wettest place!

''It was the kind of rain you wouldn't see anywhere else. We could barely see four feet ahead of us. We could touch the clouds, smell the clouds, and taste the clouds" said a local resident. Yes, it is about Mawsynram which is located in Meghalaya's East Khasi Hills, with the cluster of about 1,000 homes. It holds the Guinness Record for "the wettest place on earth". The average annual rainfall is 11,861mm, according to the Guinness website.





However, the soil in the limestone plateau doesn't absorb water. There is barely any forest cover, so a lot of erosion of top soil happens. All of it flows down into Bangladesh. The irony is that "the wettest place on earth" grapples with an acute water shortage after monsoon ends around October. Hence, people call world's rainiest place Mawsynram, which is also world's wettest desert.

Agriculture in India mostly depends on the rainfall brought by the monsoons.

During the El Nino year the temperature of the ocean water increases. This weakens the high pressure over Indian Ocean thereby reduces the strength of south west monsoon over south Asia. However during winter, it induces the low pressure over the ocean resulting in severe depressions and cyclones.

6.4.9 Tertiary Winds

The tertiary winds are formed due to pressure gradients which may develop on a local scale because of differences in the heating and cooling of the earth's surface.

Sea and Land Breezes

During daytime, land heats up much faster than water. The air over the land warms and expands leading to form low pressure. At the same time, the air over the ocean becomes cool because of water's slower rate of heating and results in formation of high pressure. Air begins to blow from high pressure over ocean to the low pressure over the land. This is called as

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